



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Liberty Academy of Columbus
School Website: <https://www.libertyacademycolumbus.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Liberty Academy Columbus (Columbus, IN 47203) demonstrates broad and deliberate alignment with classical education ideals across all six rubric categories. Public materials emphasize a time-tested, virtue-centered classical curriculum (great books, liberal arts, Latin), teacher-centered pedagogy with Socratic discussion and memory-work, and a strong partnership with parents as co-educators. The school explicitly frames its mission as forming character and civic virtue, with education of the whole child (mind, body, spirit) and limited technology use. Parental involvement is actively cultivated through information sessions, open houses, and parent-practicum events, and the faculty are portrayed as moral exemplars and living curriculum. While the site notes its private, non-parochial status, it also situates its campus within a church setting and references the church in partnership language, which strengthens its religious/metaphysical underpinnings without implying parochial control. Overall, Liberty Academy Columbus is CLASSICAL across the six categories, with a robust, explicit classical program and strong parental partnership.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Emphasis on truth, good, beauty; moral character; church affiliation in campus usage; Western tradition framing; time-tested methods.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include truth, good, beautiful; virtue; moral character; church; Western tradition; time-tested classical methods. No explicit negative signals detected in the public materials. Why this rating: The materials foreground transcendentals and virtue, with references to moral formation and classic Western heritage, and mention of church involvement in campus context, supporting a strong classical orientation in this dimension.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Mission to cultivate minds and guide hearts through classical methods; formation of virtue; education of the whole child; pursuit of truth, good, and beautiful.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive terms include formation, virtue, moral character, wisdom, liberal education (as implied by "classical methods" and "great books"), and telos/true-good-beautiful framing. No conflicting negative signals detected. Why this rating: The school explicitly frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a classical telos centered on truth, goodness, and beauty.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Liberal arts orientation (grammar, logic, rhetoric); great books; Latin; history studied throughout; emphasis on the Great Books and the Great Conversation; emphasis on wonder. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, classics, Latin, history, Western civilization, and contemplation/wonder. No explicit negative signals detected in public content. Why this rating: The site clearly maps to central classical-curriculum markers (grammar/logics/rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, historical breadth, and cultivation of wonder).
- **Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Socratic discussion in upper grades; memory work; chanting/narration in lower grades; restfulness and scholé; upper-school rhetoric and oratory; semi-

nars/debates; teacher-centered expert instruction; emphasis on wonder.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Socratic seminar, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, restfulness/scholé, seminar, rhetoric, and upper-school oratory. Negative signals (constructivist, project-based) are not present in the public content; the pedagogy described aligns with classical method expectations. Why this rating: The school emphasizes a progression from memory and chant in the lower grades to Socratic dialogue and rhetoric in the upper grades, which matches the classical pedagogy pattern.

- **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Faculty described as virtuous mentors and living curriculum; emphasis on character and expertise; teacher as exemplar; portrait of teacher; collegial culture; examples of faculty recruitment in line with classical standards. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, and collegial culture. Negative signals (e.g., “facilitators on the side”) are not indicated in public content. Why this rating: The materials portray teachers as moral exemplars and central to the curriculum, consistent with classical faculty norms.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Explicit emphasis on parent partnership, co-teaching role for parents, parent formation, classical book clubs, open-campus and volunteering, and frequent parent-facing events (information sessions, open houses, practicums). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, open campus, volunteering, and family liturgy alignment. No consumer-language or minimal involvement signals are evident in the public content. Why this rating: The school positions parents as essential collaborators and provides numerous entry points for parental involvement and formation.

Overall aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - No major needle-moving changes are required given the strong CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories. If desired, the school could further strengthen explicit theological grounding or liturgical integration in official statements to diversify the religious/metaphysical signals without changing the core classical approach.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- **Evidence**
 - The mission emphasizes formation through moral character and civic virtue within time-tested classical methods, rooted in Western tradition.
 - The public materials frame truth, goodness, and beauty as central to education, and emphasize moral character.
- **Positive/Negative keyword analysis**
 - Positive keywords observed: truth, good, beautiful; virtue; moral character; church contextual references; Western tradition; time-tested classical methods.
 - Negative keywords observed: none clearly present in public materials.
- **Why this rating**
 - The materials foreground transcendentals (true/good/beautiful) and virtue, with chapel/church context as a campus anchor, aligning with the transcendental/moral realist dimension, even as the school states it is non-parochial.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- **Evidence**
 - Mission states cultivation of minds and hearts through classical methods with moral character and civic virtue.

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- Vision emphasizes formation and the education of the whole child (mind, body, spirit) and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: formation; virtue; moral character; civic virtue; liberal education (as implied by classical mission); pursuit of true/good/beautiful.
 - Negative keywords observed: none clearly present.
 - Why this rating
 - The school frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a telos aligned to truth, goodness, and beauty, consistent with CLASSICAL orientation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit reference to liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books; Latin; history across the curriculum; emphasis on the Great Conversation and wonder.
 - Public materials describe education of the whole child and the use of classical texts as core content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; classics; Latin; history; Western civilization; great conversation; wonder.
 - Negative keywords observed: none clearly present in public content.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum is anchored in classical content areas and methods, matching core criteria of classical education.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogy includes Socratic discussion in upper grades; memory work; chanting and recitation; restfulness/scholé; seminars and debates; rhetoric training.
 - Lower grades emphasize singing/chanting and memory; upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion and rhetoric.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Socratic seminar; questioning; dialectic; recitation; chanting; memory work; scholé; contemplation; seminar; rhetoric; debate; capstone orations.
 - Negative keywords observed: none in public content (no sign of exclusive project-based/constructivist emphasis in the materials provided).
- Why this rating
 - The pedagogy is strongly aligned with classical methods through a staged progression from memory/chant to Socratic discourse and rhetoric.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Faculty described as virtuous, exemplary mentors; “living curriculum”; focus on character and expertise; portrait of teacher; collegial culture; explicit hiring of upstanding character.
 - Job postings emphasize classical education principles and teacher excellence (Upper School Mathematics Teacher; Upper School Teacher).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; great books seminars for faculty; moral exemplars.
 - Negative keywords observed: none clearly present in public content.
- Why this rating

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- The materials portray the faculty as central, virtuous, and exemplary, consistent with classical expectations for the “living curriculum” and teacher-led formation.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Strong emphasis on parent partnerships; co-teaching model; parent formation; open campus; volunteering; parent covenants; parent seminars/book clubs; family-liturgy alignment.
 - Frequent parent-facing opportunities: enrollment information sessions, parent practicums, open houses, etc.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental primacy; parent formation; seminars; book clubs; open campus; volunteering; family liturgy alignment.
 - Negative keywords observed: none clearly present.
- Why this rating
 - The school positions parents as essential co-educators and provides multiple channels for parental involvement and formation, fitting classical/community expectations.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required given the CLASSICAL ratings across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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